

When AI Image Detectors Travel

Source-heldout diagnostics for physical, neural, and frozen-encoder forensics

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Key Evidence

0.845 / 0.918

Physics-guided Ishu
same-domain accuracy / AUC

0.636 / 0.864

Frozen CLIP transfer
Ishu → MS COCOA1 accuracy / AUC

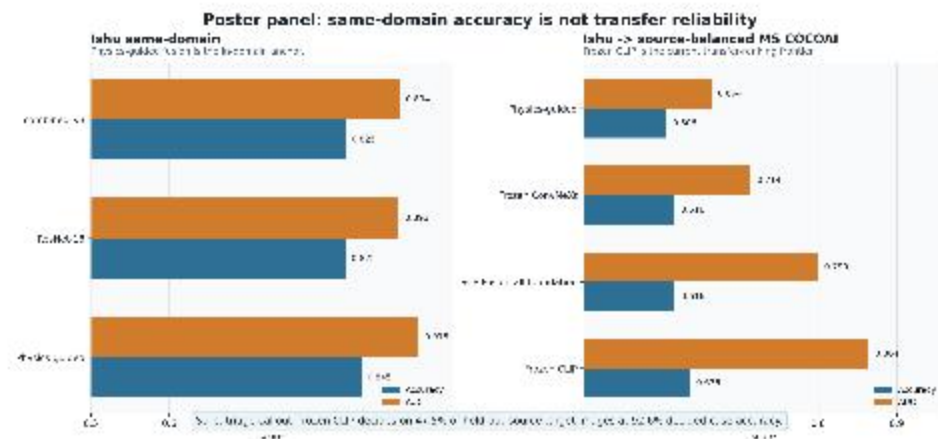
47.5% @ 92.6%

Strict CLIP triage
coverage / decided-case accuracy

0.763 / 0.836

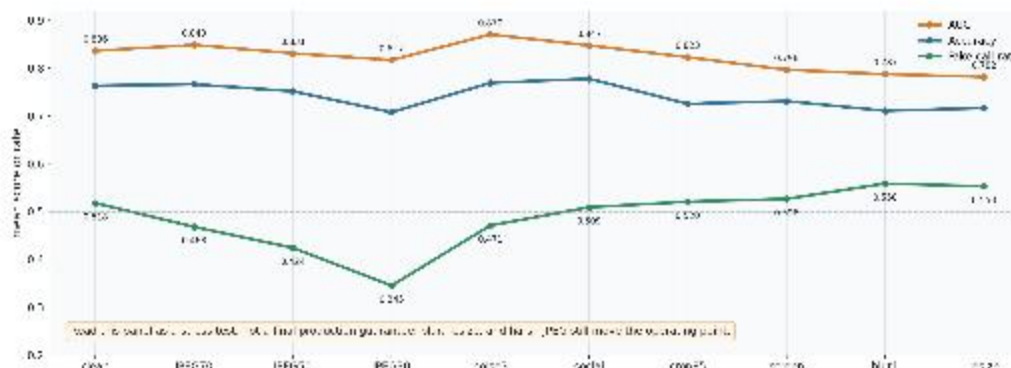
Reverse tuned fusion
best capped operating point

Working claim: same-domain wins
do not guarantee transfer
reliability; ranking, calibration,
fake-call rate, and triage split
under source shift.



Poster panel: processing shift changes ranking and fake-call behavior

Revised panel: This panel shows the source-balanced MS COCOA1 accuracy for Ishu. The y-axis lists three methods: Physics-guided, Frozen CLIP, and Reverse tuned fusion. The x-axis shows accuracy (AUC) for two datasets: MS COCOA1 and MS COCOA2. The legend indicates that orange bars represent accuracy and blue bars represent AUC.



What This Means

CLIP is the transfer frontier

The current strongest standalone cross-domain ranker is frozen CLIP, not score fusion.

Physics helps the anchor

Physics-guided ResNet improves the same-domain Ishu result and remains interpretable.

Triage is the forensic story

High-confidence two-threshold decisions are cleaner than forcing every image through 0.5.

Do not overclaim robustness

JPEG30, blur, resize, and screenshots still move the operating point.

Next Paper-Critical Step

Run the full repeated-seed combined_v4 transfer check, then decide whether v4 joins the main method or stays an ablation.